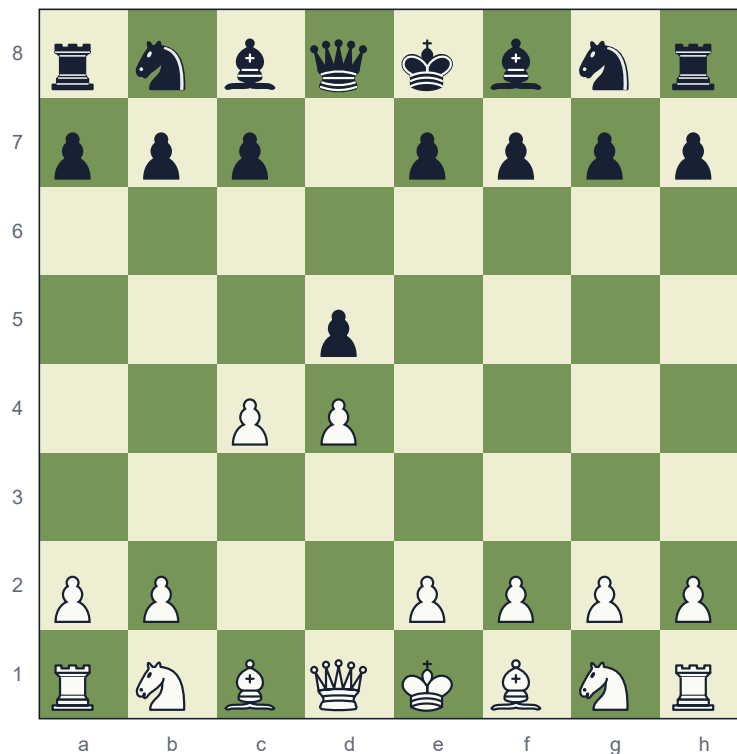


Your 1.d4 repertoire

A complete practical course built around 1.d4 and 2.c4

One coherent White repertoire, with common Black counters, plans after move ten, and exercises. Prepared for a club player who knows the rules and wants to study seriously. Use the foundation pages first if notation or pawn structures are new.



The starting question: how will Black answer the central challenge?

WHAT YOU RECEIVE

27 separate study booklets, a combined volume, 95 selected opening branches, 60 exercises with answers, eight illustrative middlegame continuations, a 12-week plan, and PGN companions for replaying the lines.

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This is a complete practical route against the common defenses, not an encyclopedia of every legal move or every good White system. The main course chooses lines for you; the Nimzo-Indian chapter is optional. No ten-move line predicts all of an opponent's choices.

How to think about the opening

THE PURPOSE OF 1.D4 AND C4

1.d4 controls c5 and e5 and opens the c1 bishop. c4 challenges a black pawn on d5 and makes it harder for Black to keep an uncontested center. Moving the c-pawn before Nc3 also leaves you the option of useful central tension. The point is not to make the same two moves against everything: c4 is a lever that you use when the position calls for it.

A REPERTOIRE IS A DECISION TREE

At each branch, first identify Black's last move and its threat. Then choose your move from that exact position. Do not memorize a list of ten White moves independently of Black's replies. If Black plays ...dxc4, ...Bb4+ or ...e5, your priorities may change immediately.

DEVELOPMENT AND THE CENTER WORK TOGETHER

A center unsupported by pieces can be attacked; developed pieces without central influence can be pushed around. Aim to develop both knights, give each bishop a useful job, and castle when the destination is safe. Use pawn moves that support those aims. A flank pawn move needs a reason.

DO NOT RUSH EVERY EXCHANGE

Before cxd5, dxc5 or dxe5, imagine the opponent's best recapture. Name the resulting pawn structure and open files. An exchange is useful when it wins material, improves a piece, removes a defender, or creates a favorable structure. Releasing tension merely to simplify the calculation can help Black.

How to think about the opening

KNOW WHAT IS FORCED AND WHAT IS CHOSEN

A checked king must answer the check. A hanging queen needs attention. By contrast, a fianchetto, minority attack, or bishop-development preference may have several good alternatives. The course gives you one practical route, while explicitly marking tactical warnings and optional expansions.

WHAT TO DO WHEN THE OPPONENT LEAVES THEORY

Pause and ask: Am I in check? What changed about captures, threats, and loose pieces? Which central break is now available? What is my worst piece? Look for a forcing opportunity, then choose a move that improves development or the center. An unfamiliar move is not automatically an error.

THE MOVE-TEN HANDOFF

At the final diagram of a line, stop reciting moves. State the pawn structure, the two most useful candidate moves, Black's intended break, and your least active piece. If you cannot explain these, replay the line slowly. Knowing a position after ten moves is more valuable than remembering ten moves without a plan.

PRACTICAL ANALYSIS AFTER A GAME

First annotate without an engine: where did you leave the repertoire, what did you fear, and which candidate did you reject? Then consult the matching booklet and a database or engine. Add one correction to your notes. A single position understood deeply is better than copying a long engine variation you cannot explain.

How to study each line

PASS 1: UNDERSTAND

Read the repertoire choice and both players' plans. Play the selected study line on a board. Say why the central exchange or developing move is useful.

PASS 2: RECONSTRUCT

Cover the notation and rebuild the line. Stop at a branch and explain what you would do if Black played differently. Accuracy matters more than speed.

PASS 3: START FROM THE FINAL DIAGRAM

Play a practice game from the move-ten position. Do not consult the PDF during play. Analyze the game afterward and connect mistakes to a plan or tactical oversight.

PASS 4: RETAIN

Review a line after one day, three days, one week and one month. A forgotten tactical detail returns to the front of the queue; a familiar easy line can wait longer.

NOTATION AND DIAGRAM CONVENTIONS

White is always at the bottom, matching your example. Files run a-h from left to right. Board captions identify whose turn it is. N means knight, B bishop, R rook, Q queen and K king. O-O means kingside castling; O-O-O means queenside castling.

KEEP THE ORIGINAL CHOICE COHERENT

Against ...Nf6/...e6 use Nf3 before Nc3 in the main repertoire. Against ...g6 use the fianchetto family. Against the Dutch defer c4 with g3. These are chosen routes, not claims that all alternatives are bad.

Scope, priorities and honest expectations

START WITH THE MOST USEFUL CORE

First study Booklets 01, 02, 04, 05, 08, 14 and 21. Add the rest as your games require, following Booklet 25. You do not need to memorize the entire library before playing 1.d4.

CHOSEN RATHER THAN MANDATORY

The course avoids making the Catalan, London, Colle, Trompowsky, sharp Bg5 Semi-Slav and Exchange Grunfeld additional repertoires. These can all be legitimate choices; they are outside the selected main route.

OPENING KNOWLEDGE CANNOT REPLACE CALCULATION

When the opponent deviates, check forcing moves first. An unfamiliar move can be sound. A familiar pattern can fail because one defender moved, a file opened, or a check changed the tempo.

LIMITS OF VERIFICATION

Every printed move sequence is checked for legality and every diagram is generated from its exact position. Selected White anchor moves were screened with Stockfish 18. Sample continuations are finite engine analysis, not a proof of an advantage and not a substitute for master-level updating.

THIS IS ORIGINAL TEACHING MATERIAL

The commentary, course organization and exercises are written for this course. Opening facts use public references. The middlegame continuations are training examples, not invented historical games. Sources and diagram-art credits appear in Booklet 26.

Course directory

00 START HERE - course map and foundations

01 Move orders and when NOT to play c4

02 Queen's Gambit Declined: the Exchange

03 QGD alternatives: Ragozin, Vienna and early deviations

04 Queen's Gambit Accepted

05 The Slav Defense

06 The Semi-Slav: e3 systems

07 Tarrasch and Semi-Tarrasch

08 Albin Countergambit: a complete practical answer

09 The Chigorin Defense

10 Other Queen's Gambit counters

11 Queen's Indian: the g3 repertoire

12 Bogo-Indian: meet the check with Bd2

13 Optional expansion: the Nimzo-Indian

Use these booklet numbers throughout the course. The combined PDF has outline bookmarks; each separate PDF is also listed in READ_ME_FIRST.txt.

Course directory

- 14 King's Indian: a fianchetto repertoire**
- 15 Grunfeld: keep the fianchetto**
- 16 Modern Benoni: space and the fianchetto**
- 17 Benko Gambit: the 5.b6 practical decline**
- 18 Budapest, Fajarowicz and Blumenfeld**
- 19 Dutch Defense: defer c4 with 2.g3**
- 20 Old Indian and Modern move orders**
- 21 When c4 waits: Englund and unusual first moves**
- 22 Pawn structures and plans after move ten**
- 23 Middlegame laboratory - eight training continuations**
- 24 60 exercises with explained answers**
- 25 12-week study plan and quick reference cards**
- 26 Sources, glossary and verification method**

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